

The Dance School Awards: Industry Award - Dance School of the Year

Dance School of the Year Application / Nomination Questions.

Please find below 5 questions which we will need you to answer to proceed with your nomination.

Judges will consider:

- Clear, specific achievements from the past year and why they matter.
- Evidence of positive impact on students, staff, or the wider community.
- A clearly articulated ethos and set of values.
- Thoughtful support for students with different goals and pathways.
- Clear safeguarding procedures embedded in everyday practice.
- Awareness of student wellbeing and duty of care.
- Evidence of commitment to equity, diversity, and inclusion in policies, practice, and culture.
- Strong leadership and professional standards.
- A compelling overall case for why the school stands out.

Email *

charlie@dancereality.co.uk

Full Name *

Charlie Gray

Email *

charlie@dancereality.co.uk

Phone Number *

07970250361

Dance School Name *

Dance Reality Studios

1. Tell us 3 things you are you most proud of your school achieving in the last year. *

Dance World Cup, Our Annual Theatre Show for all students, We are proud that in this cost of living issue we are still running 85 classes a week which shows how important our classes are to the students and parents

2. How would you describe your school's ethos and values? *

We pride ourselves on being an all inclusive school that provides classes for all. We are a friendly school that welcome everyone. Although we are a competitive school we also balance our competitions over the year as we believe not every weekend or every school holiday needs to be filled with dance events, training and competitions as a balanced family list for teachers and our students families is also important. This is very important to us s and we always strive to find that balance.

3. How do you support both recreational and aspiring professional students? *

We run 85 classes a week with some classes being recreational, some just our competitive teams and also mixed ability classes. Although we do run separate competition classes to push those looking for a potential career we also have these students in general classes as those there purely for a hobby need dancers to aspire to. We do treat everyone as an individual and guide each student so they can be the best they can be. We also run an annual in house competition for those dancers not in our competitive teams so they can experience competing and they love this event and it's great to boost confidence. Our annual theatre show is also open to all students.

4. What does safe guarding and student wellbeing look like in practice at your school? *

Safeguarding and student wellbeing are at the heart of everything we do. In practice, this means maintaining a safe, inclusive, and respectful environment where every student feels valued and supported. All staff are appropriately trained in safeguarding and understand their responsibilities for recognising and reporting any concerns. We have clear safeguarding and child protection policies, safe recruitment procedures, and appropriate supervision ratios. Parents and carers are kept informed, and communication is open and professional. We promote positive behaviour, encourage respect for others, and support students' physical and emotional wellbeing by creating a nurturing atmosphere where they can build confidence, express themselves, and enjoy learning dance safely. Health and safety procedures, risk assessments, first aid provision, and appropriate consent for photography and medical needs are also in place to ensure the wellbeing of every student.

5. Why do you believe your school deserves this award? *

We are a friendly school that strives to meet everyone's needs. We converted some warehouses about 20 years ago to create our studios and are so proud of what we have achieved. Our dancers start with us as babies and the majority stay with us until they move onto university or college. Even then the studios has been such a big part of their lives the students that leave always come back and take class when they home which is a great compliment. The studios is their second home and safe space and we are so proud to have achieved this. We have really talented dancers and are really proud that we have built a school that supports all levels of dancers, have found a balance between the competitive aspect but still have enough time for family life. We run 85 classes a week. Our teachers have been with us for many years so we don't have a high turnover of staff which we feel represents what we have achieved. Obviously we have great success in exams and competitions which is great but we deserve to win for creating a studio to be proud of with content students and families.

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